Dallas Friends Meeting
5828 Worth Street
Dallas, Texas 75214

March 8, 2026

This letter is to affirm that the Dallas Friends Meeting received this statement of conscience from our faithful attender Iniyan Joseph dated January 15, 2026. We know that it is a statement of his sincerely held religious belief against war and any participation in it. The Clerk of the Meeting and the members of the Ministry and Oversight Committee sign our names in support of his statement and attest to its sincerity.

Lulee J. Palmer
CLERK - DALLAS Friends Meeting.

Ministry and Oversight:

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January 15 2026

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Subject: **Letter of Conscientious Objection**

To whom it may concern,

It is the assumption of democracy and international law that all human beings are born free and equal in dignity and rights. That they are endowed with reason and conscience and should act towards one another in a spirit of brotherhood. That everyone has the right to life, liberty, and security of person, regardless of any nationality or status.

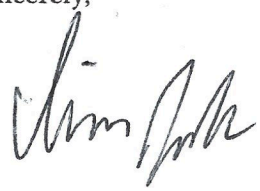
No value is more universal across cultures and faiths than the care for human life. I personally believe that life is sacred. Thus, I hold that to kill another is a sin. In war, the lives of humans, regardless of their statuses as civilian or soldier, foreign or domestic, are forfeit. I find that it is a morally weak position to respond to the effects and fear of one sin by committing another, and immoral to justify the means by the ends. Thus, it is my deeply held belief that all war is a sin.

My family has witnessed war from afar. My family grew up in an unaffiliated country during the Cold War and saw the horrific acts committed by the US and the USSR. I personally witnessed multiple fruitless American wars in the Middle East. These experiences contributed to my belief that war and militarism will not fix the problems of our nation and will only lead to more fighting, and that true peace will never be found through war.

And so I remember, in the face of violence and fear, the call to action of Martin Luther King Jr. in his "I Have a Dream" speech: "In the process of gaining our rightful place, we must not be guilty of wrongful deeds. Let us not seek to satisfy our thirst for freedom by drinking from the cup of bitterness and hatred." I remember the words of Jesus of Nazareth: "Blessed are the peacemakers." I remember the words of George Fox: "We are a people that follow after those things that make for peace, love, and unity; it is our desire that others' feet may walk in the same, and do deny and bear our testimony against all strife, and wars."

And so, in clear conscience, I cannot join the military or the military-industrial complex as a combatant or noncombatant.

Sincerely,



To whom it may concern:

My name is Marina and I am a current undergraduate at UTD who met Iniyan through school. I've had the opportunity to talk with Iniyan in depth this past year and now consider him to be one of my closest friends. If I had to describe Iniyan in one word, it would be humanist. He cares deeply about others, both in his immediate community and beyond. In his view, there are no cultural, religious, racial, or national differences that could ever diminish the value of a human life. It's easy to say that you don't support war and egregious human rights violations, but the way Iniyan lives speaks to his character. There are many examples I can give of him living out this belief. Iniyan informed our friend group of a panel discussion with experts that was being given at the local library on prison reform in Texas and offered to drive anyone interested. He did the same for another panel discussion to discuss advancing the rights of people with disabilities. Iniyan's forwarding of emails or events from Human Rights Dallas or Friends webinars is a frequent occurrence. He signs petitions and informs us of things we can do to help in our little way. Iniyan was the one who told me that most chocolate production is based on slavery, even in the modern day, and to look for the Fair Trade symbol on any chocolate packaging so that I don't support slavery or child labor. He never buys any chocolate that has not been Fair Trade certified. With his love for humanity, one of his most firmly held convictions is that war is immoral. Over the past year and a half, Iniyan has done extensive research on the actions of the United States military and how it has destroyed so many lives. No justification given curbs his opposition to the idea of killing a person. I asked Iniyan once whether he would kill a man who threatened to murder his family. If he only had one bullet and couldn't aim to injure, would he kill when pressed? He responded that he would not kill another human being under any circumstance. Iniyan firmly believes that waging war is unnecessary to solve conflict and should not be used as a convenient solution to problems, as the military has used it for in the past. He is a true pacifist. I vouch for Iniyan's moral character and his commitment to standing by his beliefs.

Peace,

Marina R